

Power Automate Bootcamp: Basic

Hands-On Lab Guide

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Demo 1: Introduction to Creating a Flow

In this instructor-led demo, we will walk through the basics of Power Automate by creating a simple **instant cloud flow**. The flow will be manually triggered and use the **MSN Weather connector** to fetch current weather for a specified location. We'll also show how to view outputs in JSON format and send yourself a Teams message using the 48:notes trick.

Objectives

After this demo, participants will be able to:

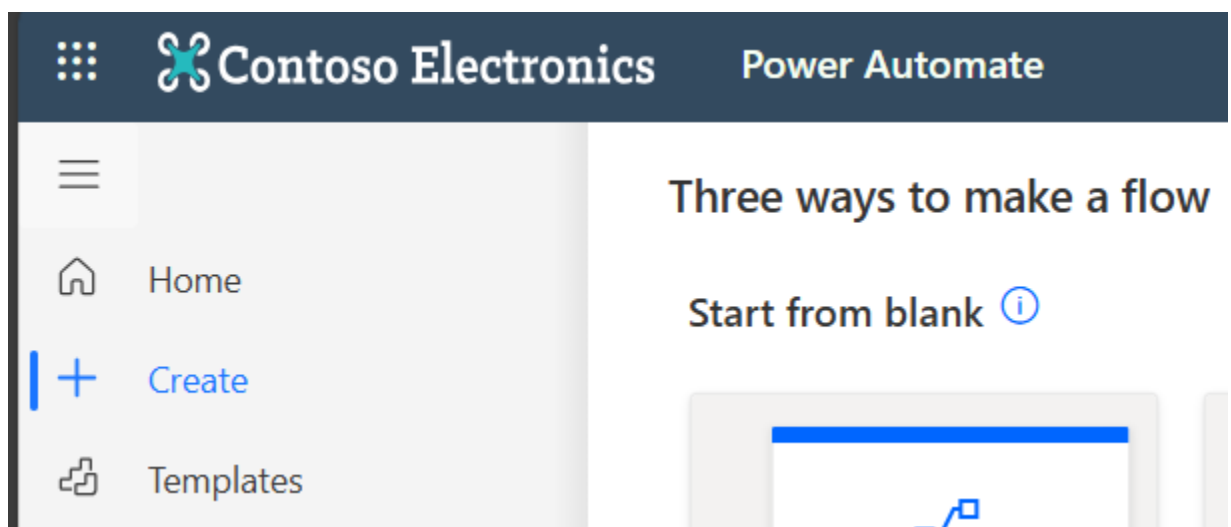
- Identify the different types of flows in Power Automate
- Create and manually trigger a basic cloud flow
- Add and configure connectors and their actions
- Authenticate connectors during flow setup
- Interpret JSON output from flow actions
- Use 48:notes to send a Teams message to themselves

Estimated time to complete this lab

20 mins (Demo Only)

Task 1: Understanding Flow Types and Connectors

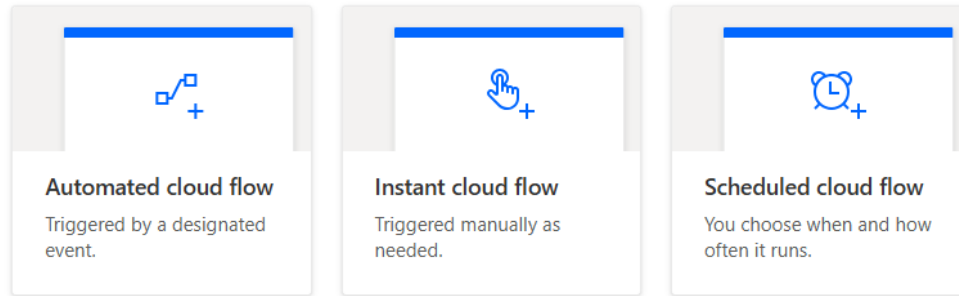
1. From the [Power Automate homepage](#), click **Create** from the left navigation.



2. Review the types of flows:

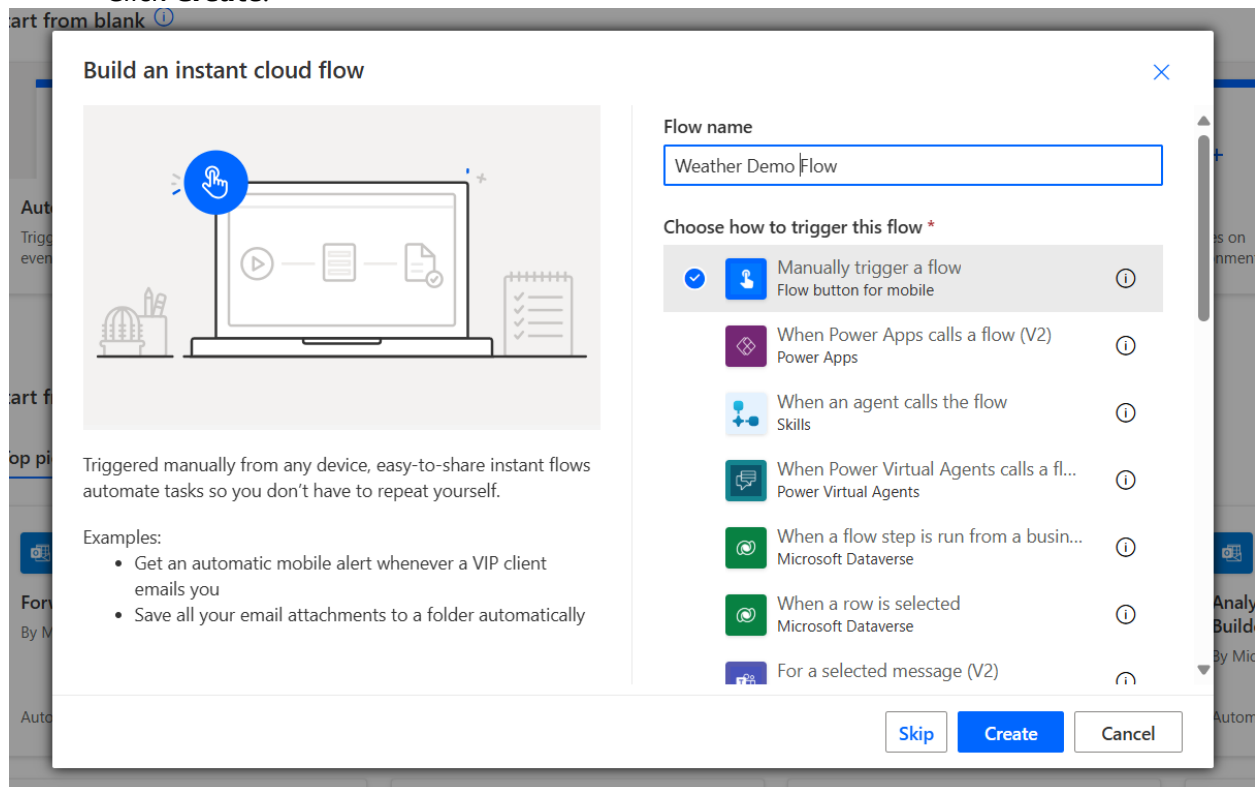
- **Automated cloud flow** – triggered by external events
- **Instant cloud flow** – manually triggered
- **Scheduled cloud flow** – runs on a timer
- **Desktop flow** – for RPA use
- **Business process flow** – guides business users through processes

Start from blank ⓘ



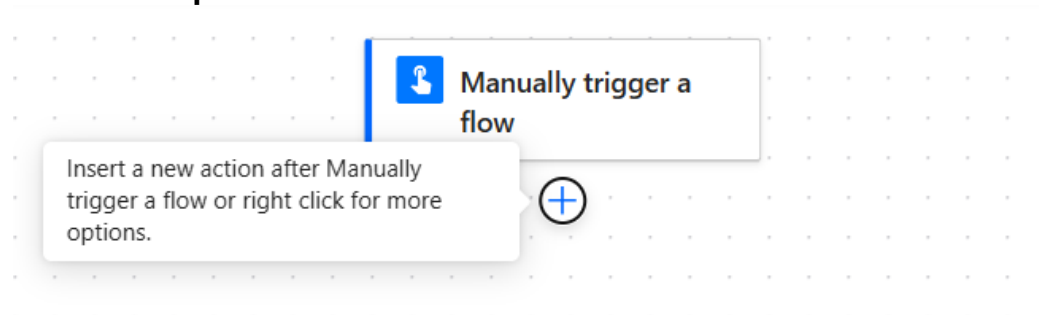
3. Select **Instant cloud flow**, name it “Weather Demo Flow”, and choose **Manually trigger a flow**.

Click **Create**.

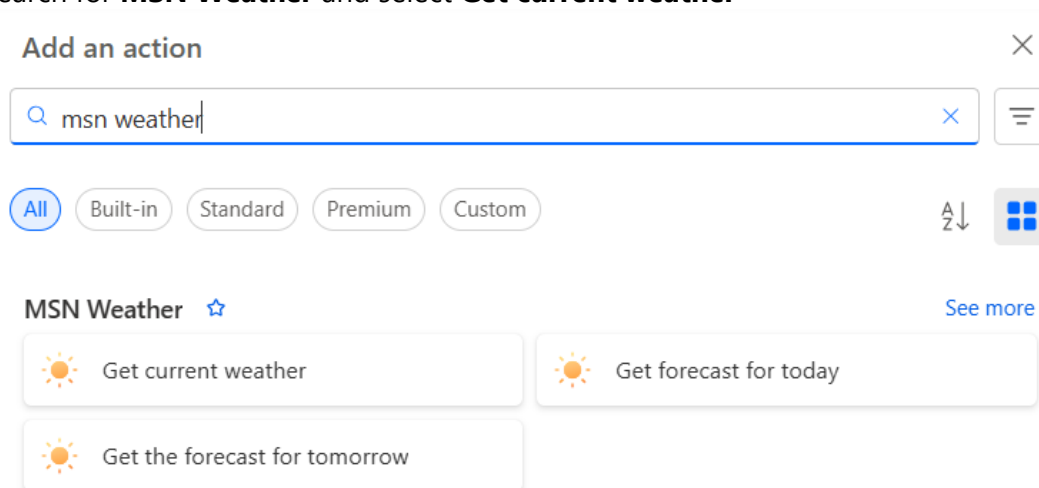


(Optional) Task 2A: Add and Authenticate MSN Weather Connector

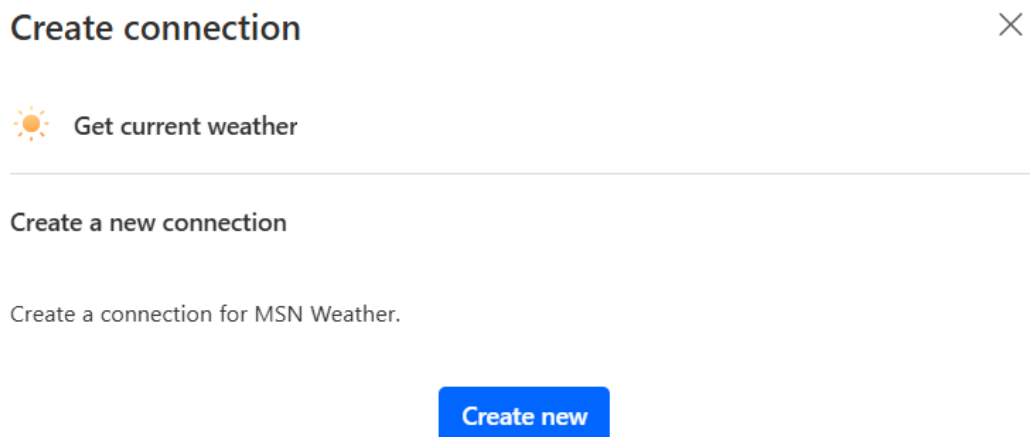
1. Click + **New Step**



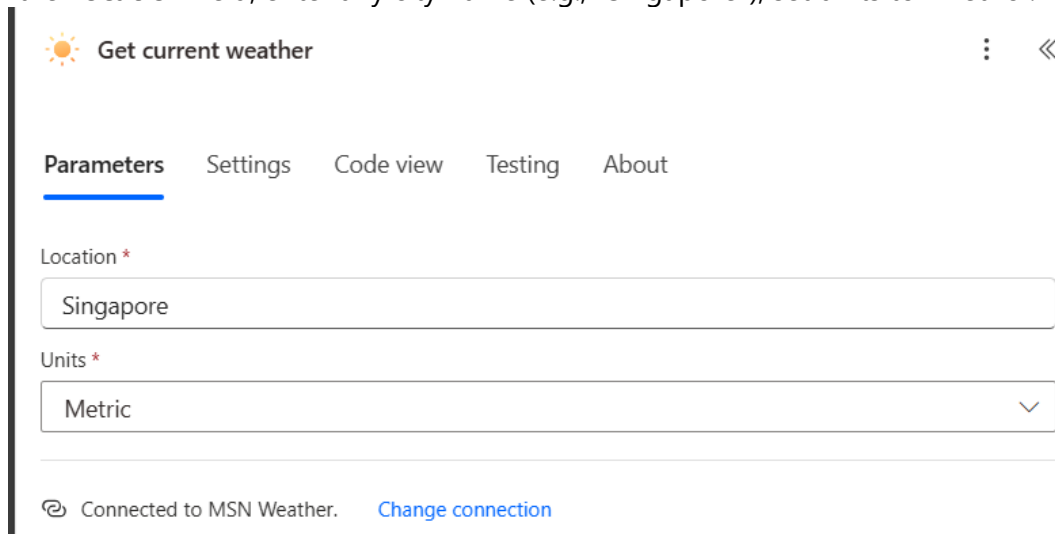
2. Search for **MSN Weather** and select **Get current weather**



3. If prompted, Create connection, sign in and grant access to authenticate the connector.

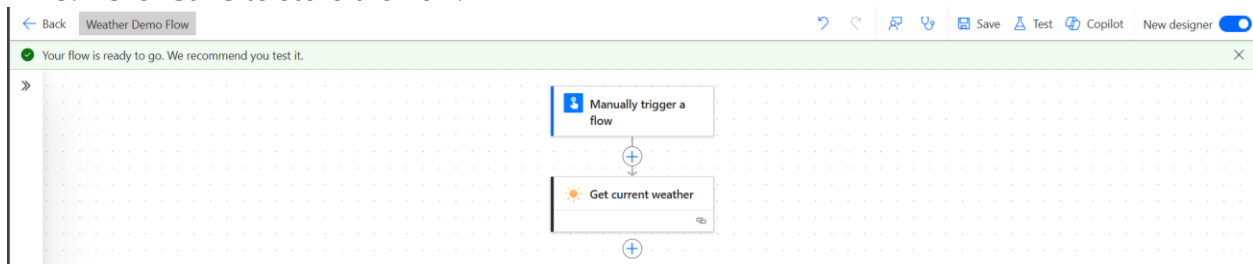


4. In the **Location** field, enter any city name (e.g., "Singapore"), set units to "Metric".



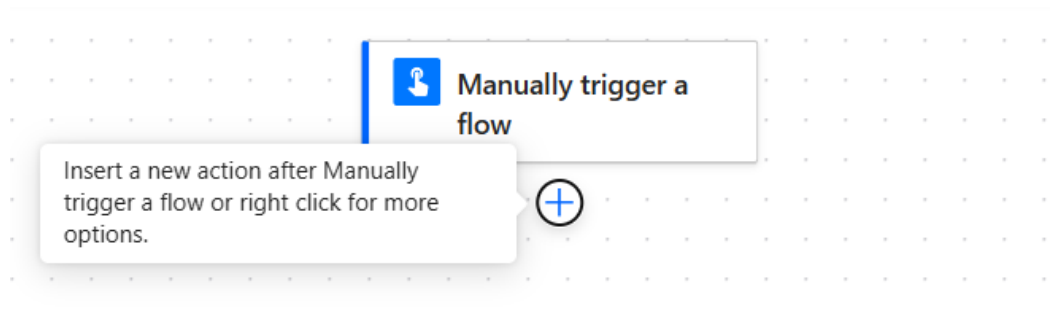
The screenshot shows the configuration interface for the 'Get current weather' connector. At the top, there's a title bar with a sun icon, the text 'Get current weather', and a close button. Below this is a tabbed interface with 'Parameters' selected. The 'Location' field is a text box containing 'Singapore'. The 'Units' field is a dropdown menu set to 'Metric'. At the bottom, it shows 'Connected to MSN Weather.' with a 'Change connection' link.

5. Click **Save** to store the flow.

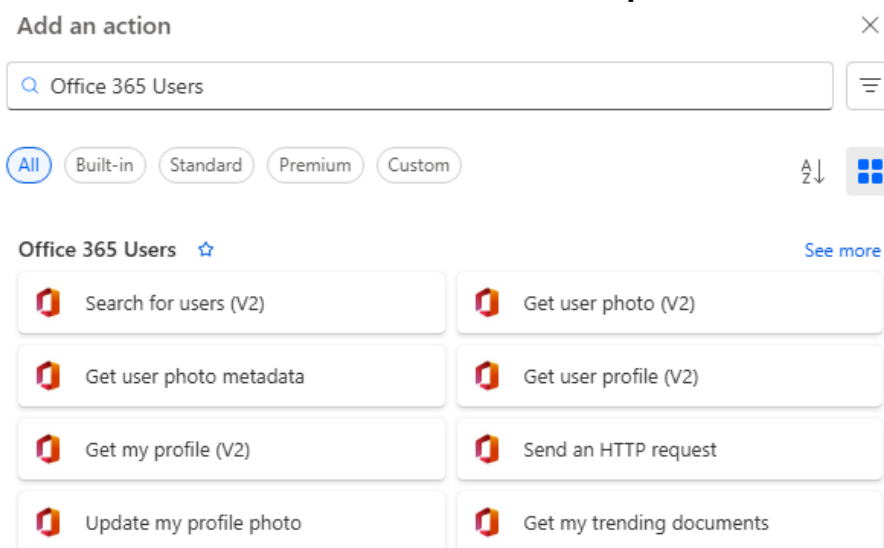


(Optional) Task 2B: Add and Authenticate Office 365 Profile Connector

1. Click **+ New Step**



2. Search for **Office 365 Users** and select **Get user profile (V2)**



3. If prompted, Create connection, sign in and grant access to authenticate the connector.

Create connection

 **Get my profile (V2)**

Create a new connection

Sign in to create a connection to Office 365 Users.

Sign in

Cancel

4. In the **Select Fields** field, enter the following mail, displayName, mobilePhone.

 **Get my profile (V2)** ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Advanced parameters
Showing 1 of 1 ▼ Show all Clear all

Select fields
 ✕

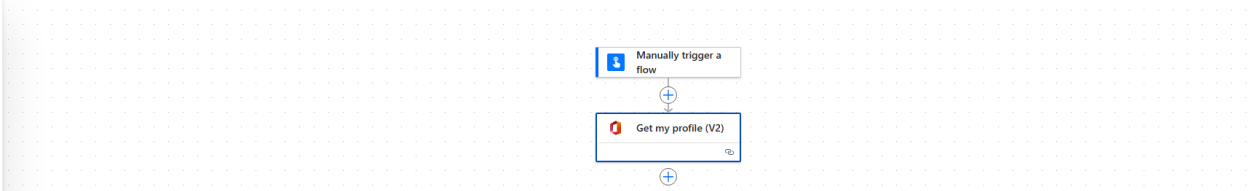
 Connected to Office 365 Users. [Change connection reference](#)

5. Click **Save** to store the flow.

← Back Office 365 Profile Demo ? ↶ ⌂ 🕒 🔄 💾 Save 🧪 Test

✔ Your flow is ready to go. We recommend you test it.

»



```
graph TD; A[Manually trigger a flow] --> B[Get my profile (V2)];
```

(Optional) Task 3A: Rename and Add Notes

1. Click title and you can rename the Card.
E.g., rename the action to Get Weather for Singapore

 Get Weather for Singapore

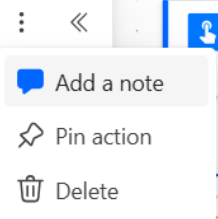
Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

2. Click on the **ellipsis (...)** on the step and select **Rename** Use **Add a note** to describe the step's function.
E.g., "Retrieves current weather using MSN Weather API"

 Get current weather

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Location *



 Get Weather for Singapore



 Retrieves current weather using MSN Weather API

Task 4: Test and Understand the Output

1. Click **Test**, choose **Manually**, and then **Save & Test, Run Flow, Done**.

Test Flow ×

☒ **Manually**
Perform the starting action to trigger it.

☐ **Automatically**
There are no runs for this flow.

Save & Test

Cancel

2. After the flow runs, expand the MSN Weather step.
You will see **Raw Outputs** in **JSON** format.

3. JSON (JavaScript Object Notation) is a structured way to store and transmit data using **key-value pairs**.

Example:

JSON:

```
{  
  "location": "Singapore",  
  "temperature": 30,  
  "condition": "Cloudy"  
}
```

This allows Power Automate to extract and use specific values like *temperature* or *condition*.

Get_Weather_for_Singapore

Get_Weather_for_Singapore

```
{  
  "body": {  
    "responses": {  
      "weather": {  
        "alerts": [],  
        "current": {  
          "baro": 1010,  
          "cap": "Partly sunny",  
          "capAbbr": "Partly sunny",  
          "daytime": "d",  
          "dewPt": 24,  
          "feels": 36,  
          "rh": 69,  
          "icon": 3,  
          "symbol": "d2000",  
          "pvdrIcon": "3",  
          "urlIcon": "http://img-s-m-sn-com.akamaized.net/tenan",  
          "wx": "RA",  
          "sky": "BKN",  
          "temp": 30,  
          "tempDesc": 9,  
          "utci": 36,  
          "uv": 7,  
          "uvDesc": "High",  
          "vis": 10,  
          "windDir": 50,  
          "windSpd": 12,  
          "windTh": 22,  
          "windGust": 21,  
          "created": "2025-06-16T06:06:08+00:00",  
          "pvdrCap": "Partly sunny",  
          "aqi": 106,  
          "aqiSeverity": "Poor air quality",  
          "aqLevel": 30,  
          "primaryPollutant": "PM2.5 0.0 µg/m³",  
          "aqiValidTime": "2025-06-16T12:00:00+00:00",  
          "richCaps": [],  
          "cloudCover": 53  
        }  
      }  
    }  
  }  
},
```

Task 5: Send a Teams Message to Yourself

1. Add a new step and select **Microsoft Teams** → **Post message in a chat or channel**

Add an action > Microsoft Teams



Microsoft Teams ☆

 Add a member to a team	 Create a Teams meeting
 Create a chat	 Create a team
 Get message details	 Get messages
 List members	 List replies of a channel message
 Post a choice of options as the Flow...	 Post adaptive card and wait for a re...
 Post card in a chat or channel	 Post message in a chat or channel

2. Choose Post as: **User**,
and Post in: **Group chat**,
under Group Chat input→ Enter Custom Value: 48:notes

This sends a message to yourself in Teams.

 Post message in a chat or channel



Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Post as *

User

Post in *

Group chat

Group chat *

48:notes

3. In the **Message** field, add something like: **For Task 3A**

The weather today in Singapore is @{body('Get_current_weather')['temperature']}°C and
@{body('Get_current_weather')['weatherText']}.

(Use Copilot to help format this if needed.)

Message *

| Normal ▾ Arial ▾ 15px ▾ | **B** *I* U

The weather today in Singapore is Temperature × and Conditions × .

For Task 3B

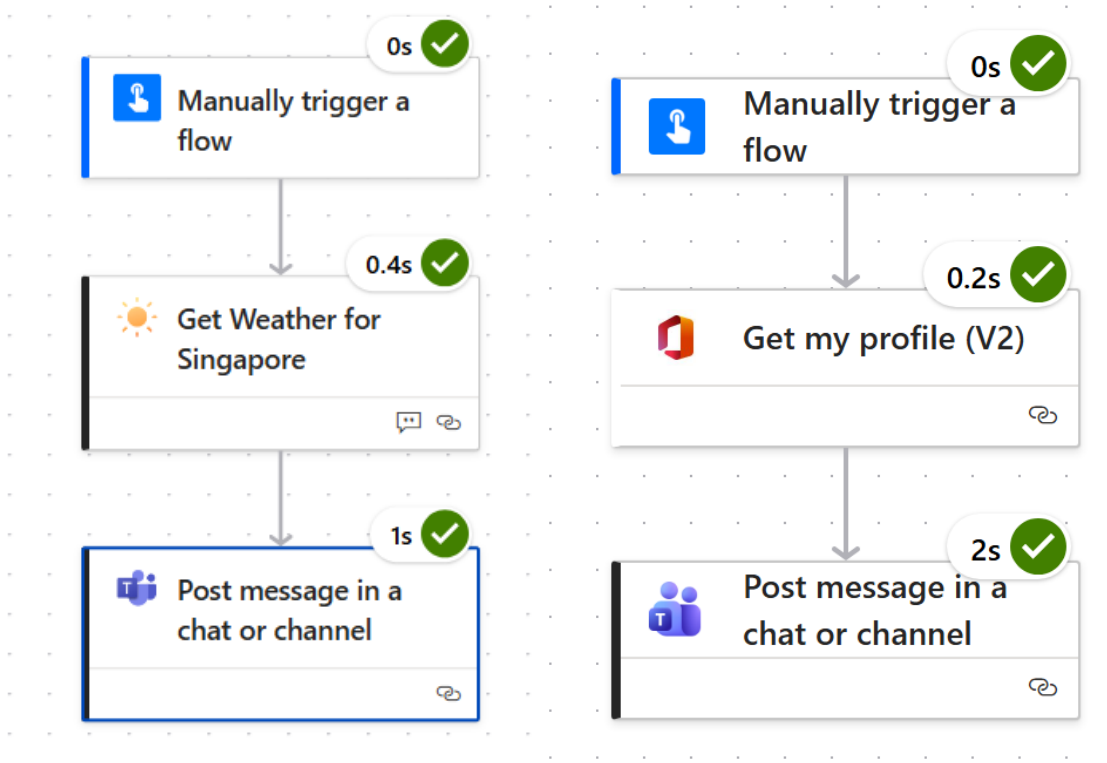
My email is @{outputs('Get_my_profile_V2')['body/mail']} and Display Name is
@{outputs('Get_my_profile_V2')['body/displayName']}

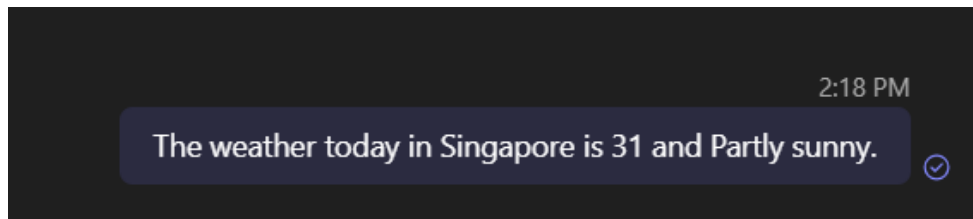
Message *

| Normal ▾ Arial ▾ 15px ▾ | **B** *I* U

My email is Mail × and Display Name is Display Name ×

4. Save and run the flow again. Check your Teams app to confirm the message was sent.





My email is admin@M365x04349104.onmicrosoft.com and Display Name is MOD Administrator 

----- **End of Task** -----

Exercise 1: Creating Your First Flow with Excel and Office 365 Connectors

In this hands-on exercise, participants will create an **instant cloud flow** that adds a new row to an Excel file stored in OneDrive. The flow will be manually triggered and use dynamic values such as the participant's profile information and current date.

Objectives

After completing this exercise, participants will be able to:

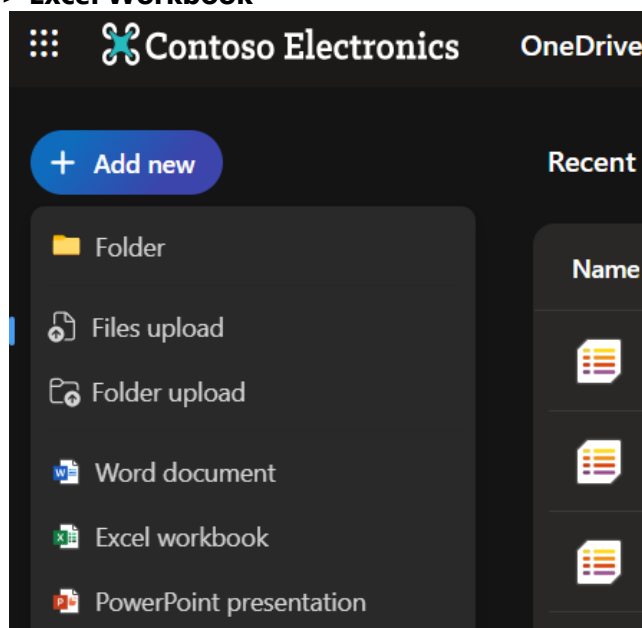
- Create and configure an Excel table in OneDrive
- Build a manually triggered flow using Power Automate
- Use the **Excel Online (Business)** and **Office 365 Users** connectors
- Populate Excel with dynamic values using flow expressions
- Format dates using the `formatDateTime()` function

Estimated Time

40–50 mins

Task 1: Creating an Excel Table in OneDrive

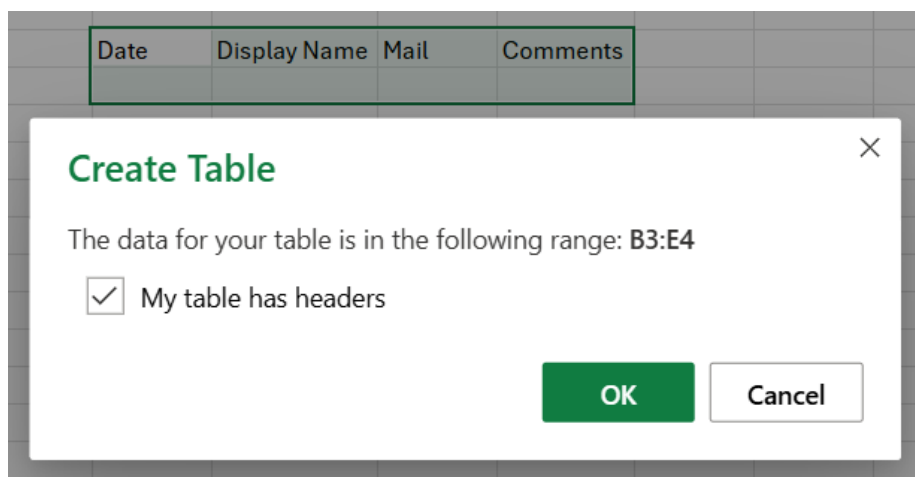
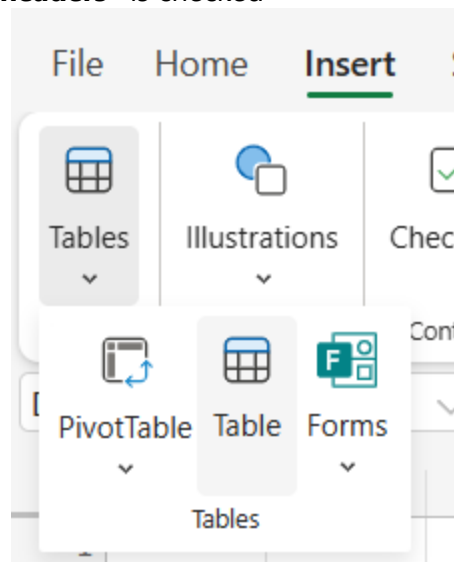
1. Go to **OneDrive for Business** and create a new Excel workbook.
Click **+Add New > Excel Workbook**



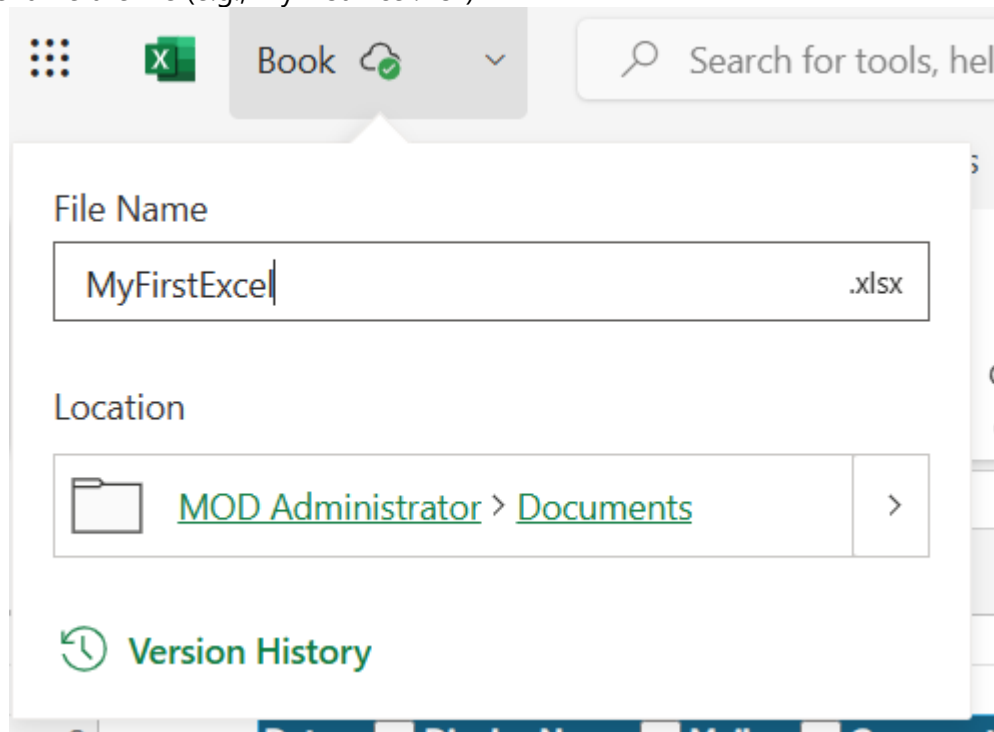
2. Inside the workbook, create the following columns:
Date, Display Name, Mail, Comments

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1						
2						
3		Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments	
4						
5						

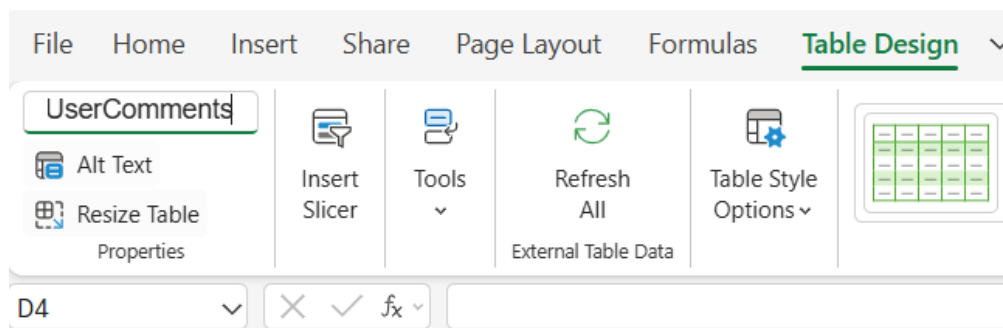
3. Select the data and insert a table via **Insert > Table**
Ensure **"My table has headers"** is checked



4. Rename the file (e.g., MyFirstExcel.xlsx)

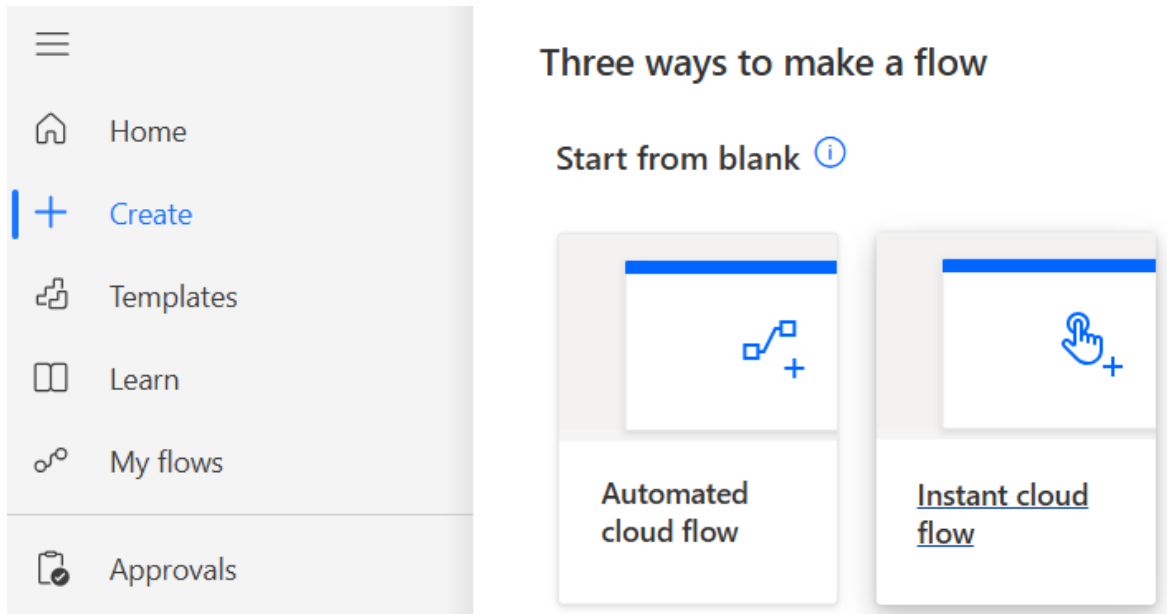


5. (Optional) Click inside the table, under the Table Design Tab and rename it from Table1 to something meaningful (e.g., UserComments)



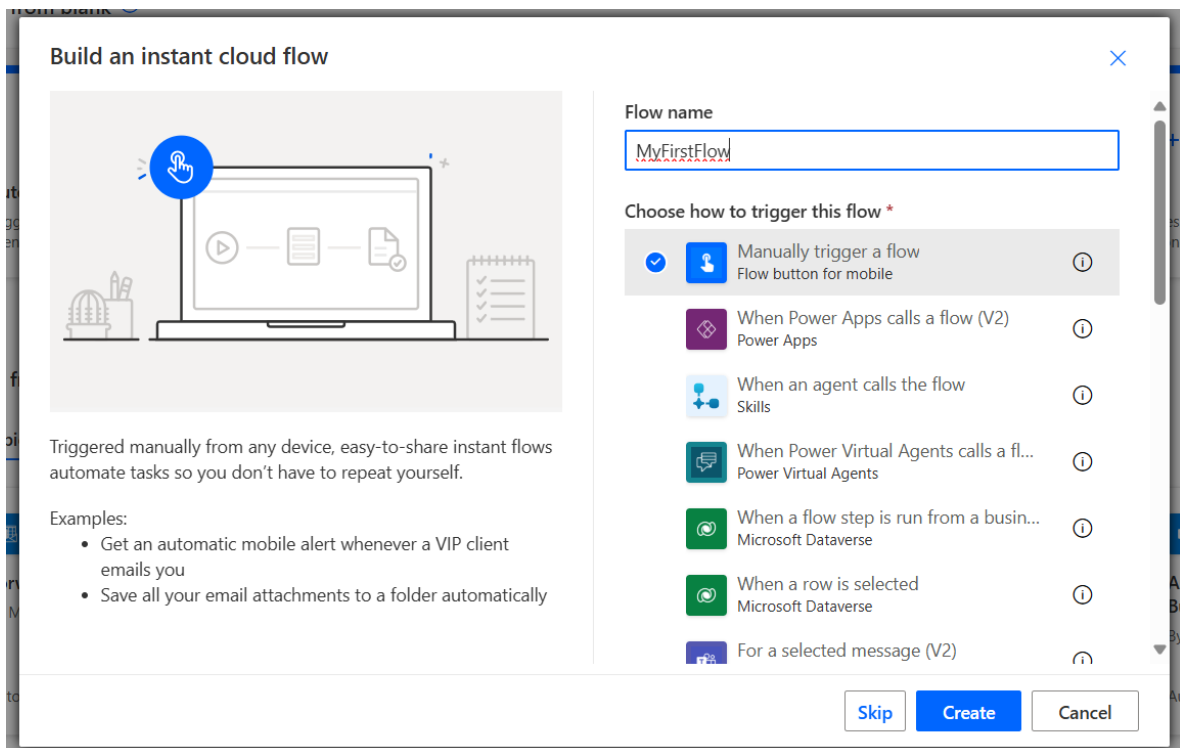
Task 2: Creating a Manually Triggered Flow

1. Go to Power Automate and click **Create > Instant cloud flow**



2. Name your flow: **MyFirstFlow**

Choose the trigger: **Manually trigger a flow**, then click **Create**



3. Click **+ New Step**, search for **Excel Online (Business)**, and choose **Add a row into a table** (Note: Sign in and create connection if it is the first time)

Add an action

excel online

All Built-in Standard Premium Custom

Excel Online (Business) ☆ See more

Get worksheets	Add a key column to a table
Run script from SharePoint library	List rows present in a table
Run script	Delete a row
Get a row	Create worksheet

Create connection

Add a row into a table

Create a new connection

Sign in to create a connection to Excel Online (Business).

Sign in

4. Select your OneDrive Excel file and the table name as shown below

Add a row into a table

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Location *
OneDrive for Business

Document Library *
OneDrive

File *
/MyFirstExcel.xlsx

Table *
UserComments

5. In the card under Advanced parameters select **Show all**, populate values:

- **Date** → utcNow()
- **Display Name** → Leave blank for now
- **Mail** → Leave blank for now
- **Comments** → Type a test comment (e.g., "Submitted via flow")

Advanced parameters

Showing 5 of 5

Show all

Clear all

DateTime Format

DateTime Format.

×

Date

 utcNow() ×

×

Display Name

×

Mail

×

Comments

Submitted via Flow

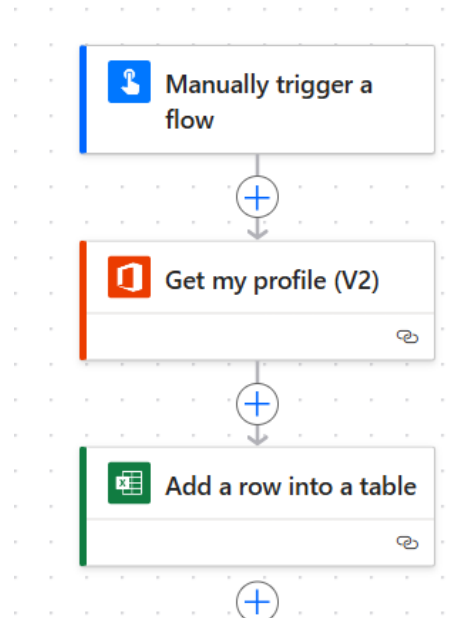
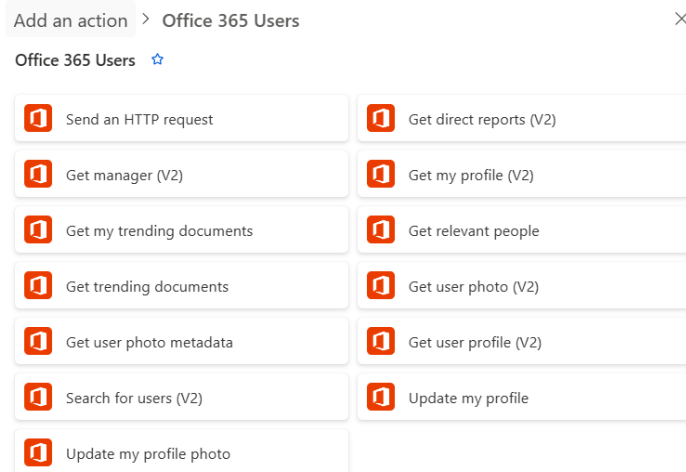
×

6. Click **Save** and **Test** the flow. Confirm a row is added to your Excel file.

Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments
2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z			Submitted via Flow

Task 3: Using Office 365 Connector for Dynamic Data

1. Add a new step between Trigger and Excel action: search for **Office 365 Users** and select **Get my profile (V2)**



2. Return to your Excel step and update the fields:
 - **Display Name** → Use dynamic content Display Name
 - **Mail** → Use dynamic content Mail

Date

X

Display Name

X

Mail

X

Comments

X

3. Improve the **Date** format. Replace `utcNow()` with:
`formatDateTime(utcNow(), 'd-M-yyyy')`

This shows the date in a readable format.

Date

 formatDateTime... 

Display Name

 Display Name 

Mail

 Mail 

Comments

Submitted via Flow

4. Save and test the flow again. Verify that the Excel row now includes your name, email, and formatted date.

Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments
2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z			Submitted via Flow
16-6-2025	MOD Administrator	admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com	Submitted via Flow

----- End of Task -----

Exercise 2: Sending Teams Messages Using Excel Data

In this exercise, you'll retrieve data from the Excel table created in **Exercise 1** and send that information to yourself via **Microsoft Teams**. This helps reinforce using dynamic content, working with connector outputs, and understanding loop behavior when multiple rows are involved.

Objectives

After completing this exercise, participants will be able to:

- Retrieve rows from an Excel table using Power Automate
- Use dynamic content from Excel in downstream steps
- Send a Teams message to themselves using 48:notes
- Understand how **Apply to each** is triggered when dealing with multiple rows
- (Optional) Format the data into an HTML table for cleaner presentation

Estimated Time

30–40 mins

Task 1: Create a New Flow to Retrieve Excel Data

1. Go to Power Automate and create a new **instant cloud flow**, Name it: **MySecondFlow**
Choose **Manually trigger a flow**, then click **Create**

Flow name

Choose how to trigger this flow *

☒	 Manually trigger a flow Flow button for mobile	
☐	 When Power Apps calls a flow (V2) Power Apps	
☐	 When an agent calls the flow Skills	
☐	 When Power Virtual Agents calls a flow Power Virtual Agents	
☐	 When a flow step is run from a business process flow Microsoft Dataverse	
☐	 When a row is selected Microsoft Dataverse	
☐	 For a selected message (V2) Microsoft Teams	

2. Add a step: **List rows present in a table** from the **Excel Online (Business)** connector

 List rows present in a table ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

3. Select the Excel file and table you created in **Exercise 1** (e.g., *MyFirstExcel.xlsx* and "UserComments" table)

Location *

Document Library *

File *

Table *

4. Save and test the flow to confirm rows are being retrieved

List_rows_present_in_a_table



List_rows_present_in_a_table

```
"x-ms-dlp-gu": "-|-",
"x-ms-dlp-ef": "-|/-|-|-",
"x-ms-mip-sl": "-|-|-",
"Timing-Allow-Origin": "*",
"x-ms-apihub-cached-response": "false",
"x-ms-apihub-obo": "false",
>Date": "Mon, 16 Jun 2025 07:05:08 GMT",
"Content-Type": "application/json; odata.metadata=minimal; odata.st
"Content-Length": "843",
"Expires": "-1"
},
"body": {
"@odata.context": "https://excelonline-ea.azurewebs
"value": [
{
"@odata.etag": "",
"ItemInternalId": "556b6085-033f-4633-a54d-5fcfdcdde16b",
>Date": "",
"Display Name": "",
"Mail": "",
"Comments": ""
},
{
"@odata.etag": "",
"ItemInternalId": "55de1a0d-6553-4d11-8c6b-468a2297c2a6",
>Date": "2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z",
"Display Name": "",
"Mail": "",
"Comments": "Submitted via Flow"
},
{
"@odata.etag": "",
"ItemInternalId": "c14372bb-9130-43ef-b1f1-009cdec1a3d4",
>Date": "16-6-2025",
"Display Name": "MOD Administrator",
"Mail": "admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com",
"Comments": "Submitted via Flow"
}
```

Task 2: Send a Teams Message to Yourself

1. Add a new step:

Microsoft Teams → **Post message in a chat or channel**

Choose Post as: **User**,

and Post in: **Group chat**,

under Group Chat input→ Enter Custom Value: 48:notes

This sends a message to yourself in Teams.

Post as *

User

Post in *

Group chat

Group chat *

48:notes

3. In the **Message** field, enter text using dynamic content and be creative.

Message *

Normal Arial 15px B I U A D E

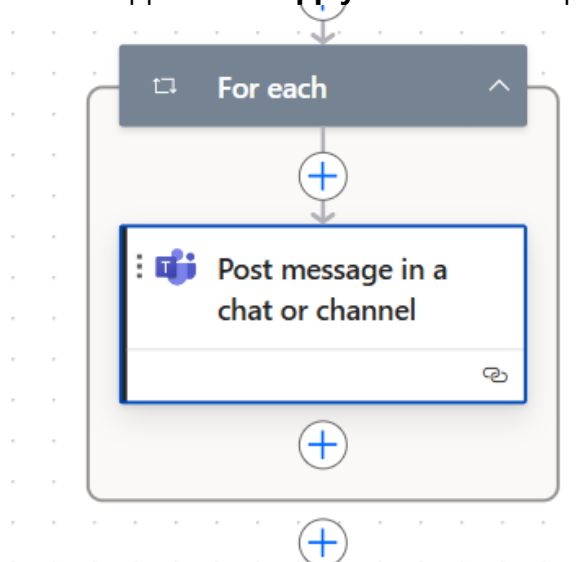
Date: fx items(...) X

Name: fx items(...) X

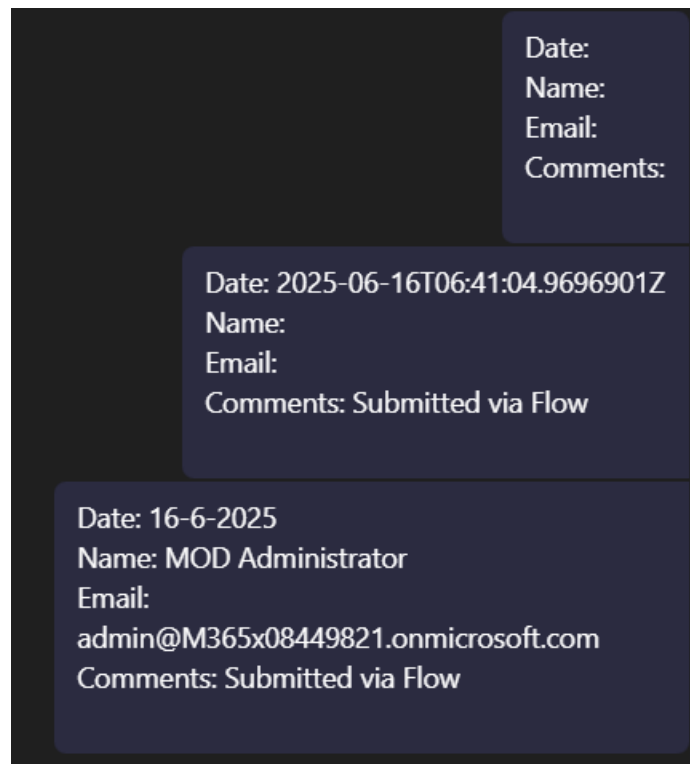
Email: fx items(...) X

Comments: fx items(...) X

(Note: This step will be wrapped in an **Apply to each** if multiple rows are present.)



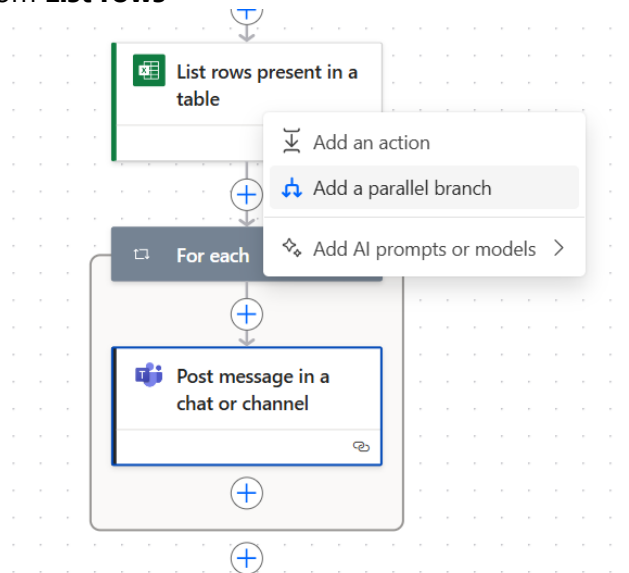
4. Save and test the flow. Open Microsoft Teams and confirm that messages were sent to yourself.



Optional Task: Use HTML Table Instead of Multiple Messages

1. Right click and Add a parallel branch step before the Teams message: **Create HTML Table**

Input: output from **List rows**



 **Create HTML table**

 **Create HTML table**



Parameters Settings Code view About

From *

 body/value X

- Replace the **Teams message** content with the output of the **Create HTML Table** action (Note: Toggle code view in the Message toolbar to enable HTML formatting)

 Post message in a chat or channel 1 ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Post as *
User

Post in *
Group chat

Group chat *
48:notes

Message *


```
<p class="editor-paragraph">
  Output
</p>
```

- This will send one formatted table instead of multiple individual messages
- Save and test again. Check that the table appears in Teams (Feel free to play around with the advanced options under create html table to adjust the headers and columns to show)

User Copilot to create a visually appealing teams body

@odata.etag	ItemInternalId	Date	Display Name	Mail	Comments
333bb509-a4d0-490d-b606-8a9ace1399c4					
f525ac09-8394-4f99-ab95-a854b2da5b0c		2025-06-16T06:41:04.9696901Z			Submitted via Flow
4ef854ec-9caa-4199-b2fa-065c67ae56eb		16-6-2025	MOD Administrator	admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com	Submitted via Flow

----- End of Task -----

Exercise 3: Automating Approvals from Microsoft Forms

In this exercise, participants will build an **automated flow** that is triggered by a Microsoft Form submission. The flow will send an approval request, and based on the outcome, a Teams message will be sent to the requester. This introduces the **Approvals connector**, conditional logic, and reuses the 48:notes technique from earlier exercises.

Objectives

After completing this exercise, participants will be able to:

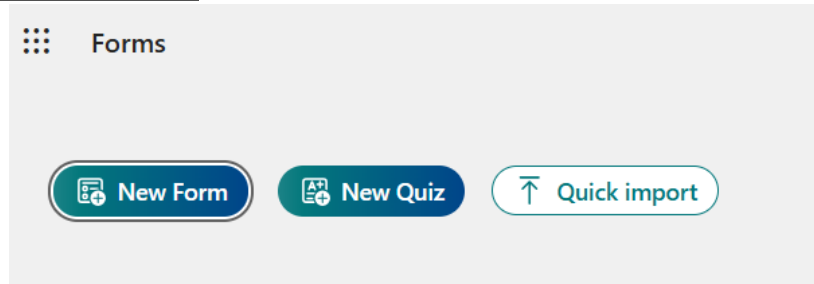
- Create an automated flow triggered by a Microsoft Form
- Use the **Start and wait for an approval** action
- Receive and respond to approval requests via Teams and email
- Add conditional logic based on approval outcome
- Send Teams notifications to themselves using 48:notes

Estimated Time

40–50 mins

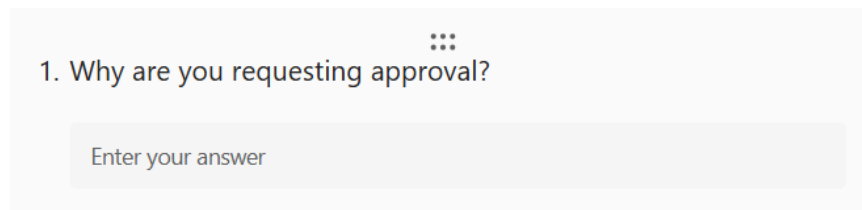
Task 1: Create a Microsoft Form

1. Go to **Microsoft Forms** and click **New Form**



2. Name the form: **Demo Form**
3. Add a **single text question**, e.g.: "Why are you requesting approval?"

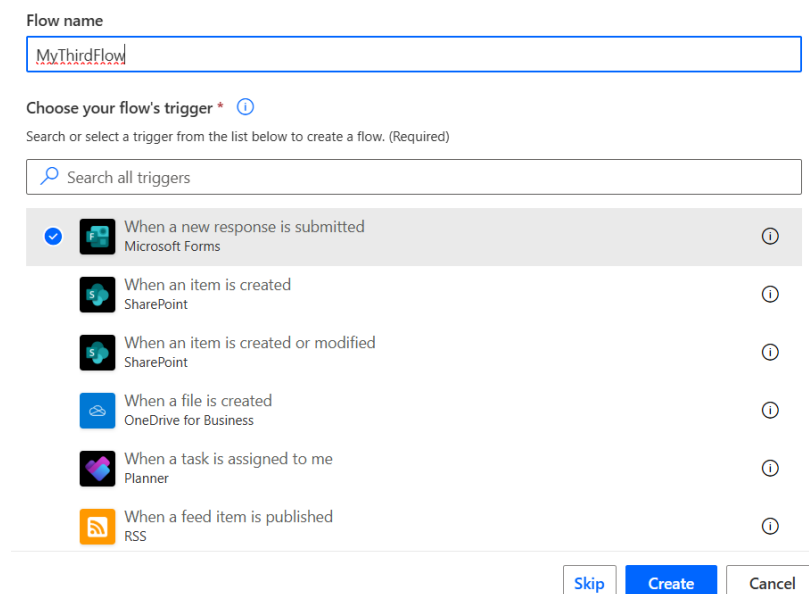
Demo Form



Task 2: Create an Automated Approval Flow

1. In Power Automate, go to **Create > Automated cloud flow**
2. Name the flow: **MyThirdFlow**

Choose trigger: **When a new response is submitted (Microsoft Forms)** Click **Create**

A screenshot of the 'Create a flow' dialog in Power Automate. The 'Flow name' field contains 'MyThirdFlow'. Below it, the 'Choose your flow's trigger' section shows a list of triggers. The first trigger, 'When a new response is submitted (Microsoft Forms)', is selected with a blue checkmark. Other triggers include 'When an item is created (SharePoint)', 'When an item is created or modified (SharePoint)', 'When a file is created (OneDrive for Business)', 'When a task is assigned to me (Planner)', and 'When a feed item is published (RSS)'. At the bottom right, there are three buttons: 'Skip', 'Create', and 'Cancel'.

3. In the trigger step, select the Demo Form created earlier

 When a new response is submitted ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view About

Form Id *

Demo Form [i3a8aZfuBkS2Y4njFMuwkd3mAl-CURJKnV3VxxWYxJ1UOE5HOTZaRTc4UV... ▼

 Connected to admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com. [Change connection](#)

4. Add a new step:
Get response details (Microsoft Forms)
 - **Form ID:** Demo Form
 - **Response ID:** Use dynamic content from the trigger

 Get response details ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Form Id *

Demo Form [i3a8aZfuBkS2Y4njFMuwkd3mAl-CURJKnV3VxxWYxJ1UOE5HOTZaRTc4UV... ▼

Response Id *

 Response Id ×

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Task 3: Add the Approval Step

1. Add the **Start and wait for an approval** action

Add an action ×

All Built-in Standard Premium Custom A↓Z ⌵

Standard approvals ☆ See more

 Start and wait for an approval ⓘ ☆

 Wait for an approval

 Create an approval

 Start and wait for an approval of text

2. Configure the action as follows:

- **Approval type:** Approve/Reject – First to respond
- **Title:** Approval Request – Demo Form
- **Assigned to:** Enter your email
- **Details:** Insert dynamic content from the form response

 Start and wait for an approval ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Approval type ^{*}

Title ^{*}

Assigned to ^{*} ⚙️ ⌵

MA MOD Administrator ×

Details

Form Submission Details:

 Why are you re... ×

Item link

⚡ fx

Press '/' to insert dynamic value or expression

Describe the link to the item

3. Click **Save** and test by submitting the form

You should receive:

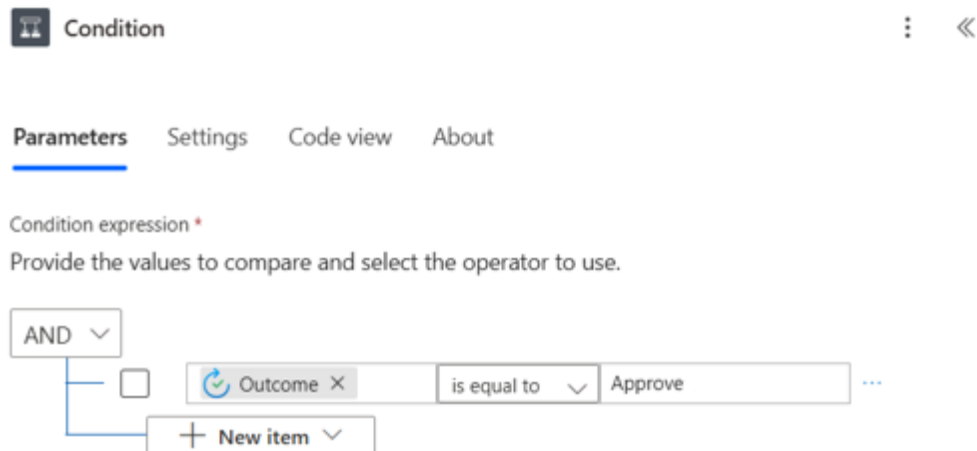
- A **Teams notification**
- An **email** with Approve/Reject buttons

The screenshot shows the 'Approvals' app interface. At the top, there's a header with the 'Approvals' logo and the text 'Approval request details'. Below this is a 'Requested' status indicator. The main title is 'Approval Request - Demo Form'. Underneath, it says 'Form Submission Details: Testing how approval works'. The status is 'Requested'. There are two entries: 'MA Pending response MOD Administrator' and 'MA Requested by MOD Administrator'. The date and time '6/16/2025, 3:46:22 PM' are shown. At the bottom, there's a 'Comments' section with a text input field 'Add your comments here'. Below the comments are three buttons: 'More actions' with a dropdown arrow, 'Reject', and 'Approve'.

The screenshot shows an email notification from 'Approvals | Power Automate'. The subject is 'Approval Request - Demo Form'. The body text includes: 'Requested by MOD Administrator <admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com>', 'Date Created Monday, 16 June 2025 3:46 pm', and 'Form Submission Details: Testing how approval works'. Below this are two buttons: 'Approve ^' and 'Reject v'. There is a 'Comments' section with a text input field 'Enter comments' and a 'Submit' button. At the bottom, there is a footer message: 'Get the Power Automate app to receive push notifications and grant approvals from anywhere. Learn more. This message was created by a flow in Power Automate. Do not reply. Microsoft Corporation 2020.'

Task 4: Add Conditional Logic

1. Add a **Condition** control
Set the condition: is equal to Approve



Condition

Parameters Settings Code view About

Condition expression *

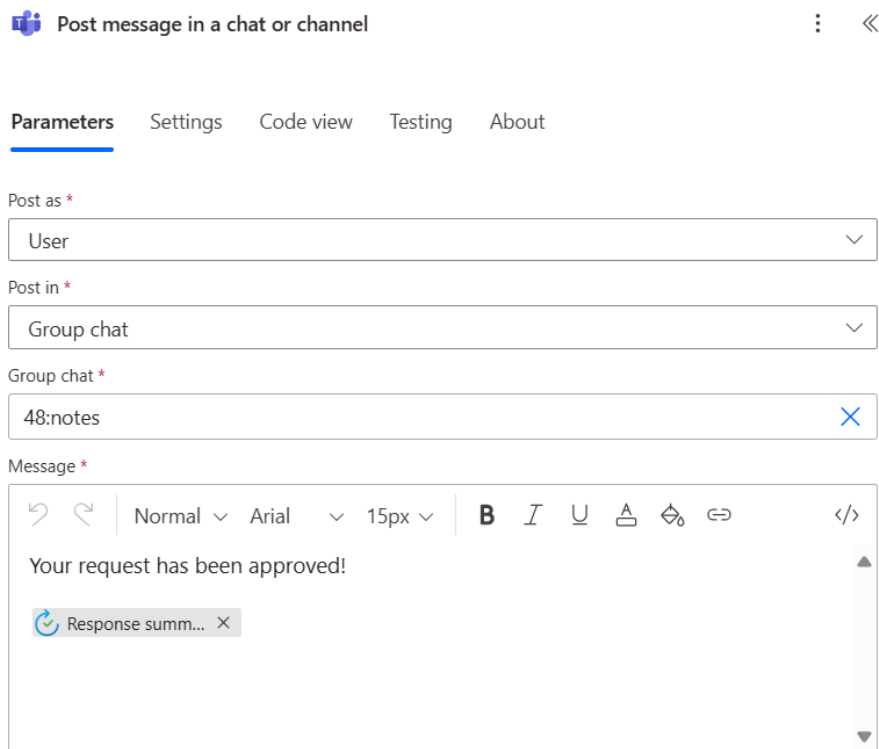
Provide the values to compare and select the operator to use.

AND

Outcome is equal to Approve

+ New item

2. In the **If yes** branch, add:
Microsoft Teams → **Send message in a chat**
 - Recipient: 48:notes
 - **Message:** "Your request has been approved!"



Post message in a chat or channel

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Post as *

User

Post in *

Group chat

Group chat *

48:notes

Message *

Normal Arial 15px B I U A E

Your request has been approved!

Response summ...

3. In the **If no** branch, add a similar message:

 Post message in a chat or channel 1 ⋮ ⏪

Parameters Settings Code view Testing About

Post as *

Post in *

Group chat *

Message *

↶ ↷ Normal Arial 15px B I U   

Your request has been rejected!

 Response summ... X

Task 5: Test and View the Outcome

1. Open the Demo Form and submit a sample response

Demo Form

Hi, MOD. When you submit this form, the owner will see your name and email address.

1. Why are you requesting approval?

2. Check your email and Microsoft Teams — you should receive an **approval request**



Approvals | Power Automate

Approval Request - Demo Form

Requested by **MOD Administrator** <admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com>

Date Created Monday, 16 June 2025 4:08 pm

Form Submission Details:
Testing Approval Message

Approve ▾

Reject ▾

Get the Power Automate app to receive push notifications and grant approvals from anywhere. [Learn more](#). This message was created by a flow in Power Automate. Do not reply. Microsoft Corporation 2020.

Approvals
Approval request details

Requested

Approval Request - Demo Form

Form Submission Details:
Testing Approval Message

▼ Status: Requested

Pending response
MOD Administrator

Requested by
MOD Administrator

6/16/2025, 4:08:01 PM

Comments

Add your comments here

More actions ▾

Reject

Approve

3. Click **Approve** or **Reject** from either channel

Return to Teams and verify that the correct message was sent to yourself:

- If approved →

Your request has been approved! 🎉

- If rejected →

Your request has been rejected.

Your request has been rejected!

Approver: MOD Administrator, admin@M365x08449821.onmicrosoft.com Response: Approve Request Date: Monday, June 16, 2025 8:08:01 AM Response Date: Monday, June 16, 2025 8:10:23 AM

----- End of Task -----